# APPENDIX A – HUMAN PARTICIPANTS

*(To be completed only if applicable, as indicated by the Pre-Data Gathering Ethical Screening Checklist)*

General Information
Title of Study:_____
Proponent(s): _____
Program / Department: _____
Course / Section (if applicable):_____
Faculty Adviser (if applicable): _____

**Scope**

This appendix applies to studies that involve human participants, including but not limited to:

- Surveys or questionnaires
- Interviews or focus group discussions
- Usability testing of systems, applications, or games
- Playtesting or user experience evaluation
- Observation of user interaction
- Participation in audio, video, image, or multimedia outputs

If the study does not involve human participants, this appendix is not required.

**I. Description of Participants**

1. Type of participants (e.g., students, faculty, professionals, general public, online users)

   _____

2. Estimated number of participants: _____
3. Age group (check one):
   ☐ 18 years old and above only
   ☐ Includes minors *(requires additional justification and consent from parents)*
4. Recruitment method
   (e.g., voluntary sign-up, invitation, announcement, online posting, etc)

   _____

**II. Nature of Participation**

Participants will be involved in the study through the following activities (check all that apply):
☐ Survey or questionnaire
☐ Interview
☐ Focus group discussion
☐ Usability testing (system, app, website, prototype)
☐ Game testing or playtesting

☐ Observation of user interaction
☐ Appearance in audio, video, image, or multimedia output
☐ Other (specify): _____

**III. Informed Consent Process**

1. How will informed consent be obtained?
   ☐ Written consent form
   ☐ Digital or electronic consent
   ☐ Implied consent (e.g., anonymous online survey, voluntary participation)
2. Participants will be informed all of the following:
   - Purpose of the study
   - What participation involves
   - Voluntary nature of participation
   - Right to withdraw at any time without penalty
   - How data will be used and protected
3. Consent documentation
   ☐ Sample informed consent form/s attached
   ☐ Sample assent form attached *(if minors are involved)*
   ☐ Not applicable (explain briefly): _____

**IV. Risks, Discomforts, and Safeguards**

1. Level of risk involved in participation:
   ☐ Minimal risk (no greater than everyday activities)
   ☐ More than minimal risk *(explain and justify)*
2. Potential risks or discomforts (if any):
   (e.g., time required, mild discomfort, exposure in media)
   _____
3. Safeguards to minimize risk:
   (e.g., voluntary participation, ability to skip questions, anonymity)
   _____

**V. Privacy, Confidentiality, and Data Protection**

1. Type of data to be collected (check all that apply):
   ☐ Name or other direct identifiers
   ☐ Audio recordings
   ☐ Video or images
   ☐ Survey or interview responses

☐ System, app, or game interaction data
☐ Anonymous data only

2. How will confidentiality be protected?
   ☐ Use of codes or pseudonyms
   ☐ Anonymization of data
   ☐ Restricted access to data
   ☐ Password-protected storage
   ☐ Encrypted storage (if sensitive data)
3. Who will have access to raw data?
   ☐ Principal Investigator only
   ☐ Adviser
   ☐ Research team members
   ☐ External collaborators (specify): _____
4. Will raw data be shared outside the research team?
   ☐ Yes (explain safeguards): _____
   ☐ No
5. Data storage and retention
   a. Storage location: _____
   b. Duration of retention: _____
   c. Method of data disposal: _____
6. De-identification and Anonymization Plan
   a. Will direct identifiers (e.g., name, ID number, contact information) be collected?
      ☐ Yes ☐ No
   b. If yes, explain why collection of identifiers is necessary:

   c. How will identifiers be handled?
      ☐ Stored separately from research data
      ☐ Replaced with participant codes
      ☐ Deleted after data cleaning
      ☐ Not applicable (no identifiers collected)
   d. Will the final dataset used for analysis be:
      ☐ Fully anonymous
      ☐ Coded (pseudonymized)
      ☐ Identifiable
   e. At what stage will identifiers be removed (if applicable)?

VII. Special Considerations for Multimedia and Digital Projects

*(Complete this section if participants will appear in creative or digital outputs.)*

☐ Not applicable

☐ Informed consent for the use of participants' image, voice, or likeness will be obtained

☐ Participants will be informed of where and how the outputs will be presented or used

☐ Participants will not be deceptively or misleadingly portrayed

☐ Participants will be informed of the possibility of withdrawal or removal prior to final submission, when feasible

Note: If the study also involves broader creative or representational issues, Appendix G – Multimedia, Creative, and Game-Based Research may also be required.

VIII. Optional Clarification

*If there are any aspects of human participation, consent, risk, or data handling that require clarification and are not fully captured above, please explain briefly below.*

IX. Ethical Assurance

The proponents affirm that:

- Participation in this study is voluntary
- No participant is coerced or unduly influenced
- Risks associated with the study are minimal and proportionate to its objectives
- Privacy and confidentiality of participants are respected
- Records of informed consent and assent, where applicable, are properly documented and securely retained in accordance with institutional policy and applicable guidelines.
- The study complies with institutional ethical standards and applicable national guidelines, including those set by the Philippine Health Research Ethics Board (PHREB)

| Name | Email Address | FEUTECH ID | Contact Number | Signature |
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**Reviewed by : _____**

**(Capstone Mentor/ Thesis Adviser for students) or (Director/ Senior Director for Associates)**